BEYOND CAT PERCENTILE: WHY AN MBA APPLICANT NEEDS MORE THAN AN EXAM SCORE

CASE STUDY STRATEGY WORKSHEET: POOJA NAIR | CAT & INDIAN VS GLOBAL MBA

1. Student Persona & Challenge Diagnostic Audit

Candidate: Pooja Nair | Profile: Commerce graduate, 4 years of experience in finance.. This worksheet outlines the systematic forensic diagnostic and strategic intervention designed to resolve this admissions roadblock.

Assessment Dimension	Diagnostic Finding & Initial Challenge	Strategic Objective
Candidate Profile	Commerce graduate, 4 years of experience in finance.	Build differentiated application proposition
Core Admissions Roadblock	Pooja had focused heavily on entrance examination preparation. She assumed that improving her CAT percentile would automatically make her ap...	Eliminate systemic bottlenecks through data feedback
Root Cause Identified	Misalignment between effort and strategic execution	Shift from generic repetition to targeted intervention
Admissions Target	Competitive Global / Indian MBA Program	Maximize admit ROI and scholarship potential

Key Diagnostic Insight:

"A high test score or strong resume alone is not a substitute for a coherent admissions story. Every applicant requires a personalized roadmap that aligns quantitative readiness with distinctive leadership impact." — Mr. Surinder Gupta (IIT Roorkee)

2. Step-by-Step Strategic Intervention

- Evaluated academic and professional background.
- Identified relevant work achievements.
- Reviewed leadership and extracurricular experiences.
- Clarified post-MBA objectives.
- Evaluated relevant programme requirements.

3. Actionable Checklist for MBA Applicants

- Diagnostic First: Never increase preparation hours or rewrite essays without an objective diagnostic baseline.
- Data-Driven Tracking: Use targeted analytics to monitor error patterns rather than counting raw study hours.
- Holistic Narrative: Connect undergraduate background, career progression, and MBA goals into one cohesive arc.
- Expert Perspective: Involve senior mentors early to eliminate blind spots and stress-test interview responses.
- Advice: A preparation strategy must fit your reality. Consistency always beats sporadic marathons.

Want to understand your complete MBA profile beyond your test score? Start with a profile assessment.

Schedule a 1-on-1 strategy session with Mr. Surinder Gupta (IIT Roorkee) at www.mbawizards.co.in